

Hats off The fashion for large, heavy wigs led to men removing hats indoors because it was more comfortable without them. In summer waistcoats were abandoned for coolness in favour of a coat worn directly over the linen shirt.

1660



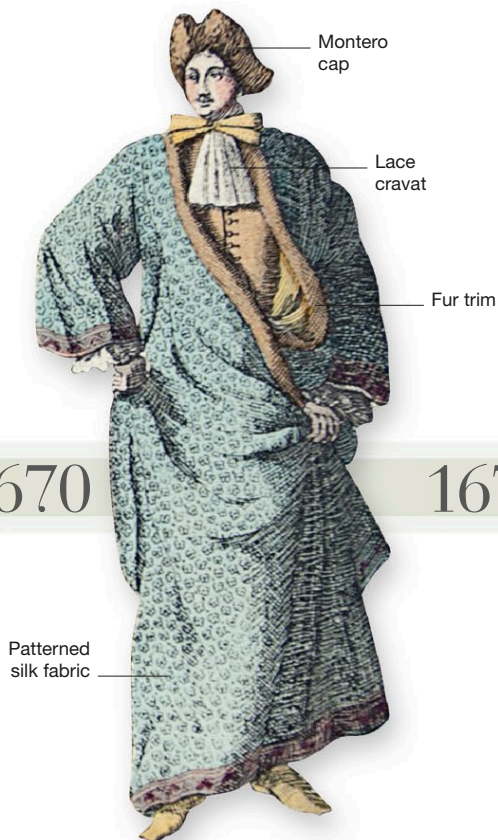
Old and new There was a new fashion for straight-cut tunics worn over a vest (waistcoat). This practical ensemble is part old-fashioned, sleeved mantle, part up-to-the-minute tunic. The broad linen collar resembles lace collars of the time but is plainer.

CHARLES II



In 1660 King Charles II returned from exile in France to take up the English throne. He was known for his love of fashionable dress and introduced styles from the French court. In 1666 he introduced a more sober style of dressing of a coat, waistcoat or vest, and breeches in black silk over white. This is seen as the origin of the three-piece suit.

1670



Home wear A nightgown was an informal garment worn at home, similar to a dressing gown. Inspired by Eastern styles it was made from rich silks or decorative printed cottons. A montero – an informal cap with flaps of fur or cloth – completed this look.

1675



Heavy wigs Long, curled, full-bottomed wigs became fashionable. Calottes (small linen caps) were worn beneath to absorb the sweat. France's Louis XIV had a large collection, and Charles II popularized this style in England when he came to the throne.



Decorative trim Fashionable hats were decorated with galloon (gold braiding), feather trims, and ribbon rosettes. Hat brims were often turned up at dramatic angles. The tiered cravat is made of layers of fine linen overlaid with lace.